

SERVING PLAN 4 SERVING PLAN

Blackened Tilapia

with Dirty Rice and Rémoulade

Cajun blackening spice typically features dried thyme, garlic powder, smoked paprika, and cayenne pepper—when charred, it adds a burst of smoky flavor to meat or fish. Tonight's tilapia is seared until the spices crisp and darken, then served over colorful rice with a creamy, tangy, slightly spicy rémoulade to bring the Louisiana flavors full circle.

40–50 minutes 470 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 2 red bell peppers
- ¼ cup sliced dill pickles
- 1 yellow onion
- 2 cloves garlic
- 1 jalapeño
- 1 cup jasmine rice
- 1 vegetable bouillon cube
- 1¼ pounds tilapia
- 1½ tablespoons blackening spice mix
- 4 ounces sour cream
- 2 packets Dijon mustard
- ¼ teaspoon ground cayenne pepper

You'll need

olive oil
kosher salt
black pepper
10" large pot with lid
12" large nonstick pan

Recipe tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking.

When mincing spicy chiles like jalapeño, avoid touching the inside, and wash your knife, cutting board, and hands afterward.

Toasting the rice adds a delicious nutty flavor and helps it soak up the colors of the red bell pepper, yellow onion, and green jalapeño—what gives dirty rice its name.

Blackening the tilapia doesn't mean you're about to burn your dinner. The generous spice rub takes on the char here, creating a delicious crust while the fish stays perfectly tender. USDA recommends cooking fish to 145°F.

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1. Prepare ingredients

Rinse all produce. Halve **bell peppers** lengthwise, discarding seeds and stems; cut into ¼-inch pieces. Finely chop **pickles**. Peel **onion** and cut into small dice. Mince **garlic**. Halve **jalapeño** lengthwise; using a knife tip, discard seeds and stem, then mince (see recipe tip).



2. Sauté aromatics

Heat **1 tablespoon olive oil** in a large pot over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, add **bell peppers**, **onion**, and **jalapeño** (skip or use half for less heat) and cook, stirring occasionally, until beginning to soften, 5 minutes. Add **garlic** and cook until fragrant, 1 minute more. Season with **½ teaspoon salt** and **black pepper** as desired. Add **jasmine rice** and cook, stirring frequently, until toasted, 2–3 minutes (see recipe tip).



3. Simmer dirty rice

To pot with rice, add **vegetable bouillon cube**, **2¼ cups water**, and **½ teaspoon salt**. Bring to a boil over high heat. Stir once, reduce heat to medium low, cover pot, and simmer until water is fully absorbed, 10–12 minutes. Remove pot from heat and let stand, still covered, for 10 minutes. Fluff **rice** with a fork, then cover again to keep warm until ready to serve.



4. Blacken tilapia

Pat **tilapia** dry with paper towel; season all over with **blackening spice mix** and **1 teaspoon salt**. Heat **3 tablespoons olive oil** in a large nonstick pan over medium-high heat. When oil is shimmering, carefully add **tilapia**, standing back in case hot oil splatters. Sear, working in batches as needed, until spices are blackened and fish is cooked through and opaque, 3–5 minutes per side (see recipe tip).



5. Make rémoulade

While tilapia sears, in a medium bowl, whisk together **sour cream**, **Dijon mustard**, **cayenne pepper** (it's a bit spicy, so feel free to adjust this to your preferences, too), **pickles**, and **1 tablespoon water** to combine. Set aside until ready to serve.



6. Plate blackened tilapia

Divide **dirty rice** among serving plates, then top with **blackened tilapia**. Dollop over **rémoulade**. Enjoy!

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